

MoSPI Reference Manual: NSSO Survey Sampling & Field Methodology

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1. Introduction to NSSO Sampling Design

The National Sample Survey Office (NSSO) employs a stratified multi-stage design for national socio-economic surveys. The primary sampling units (PSUs) are rural villages (or blocks) and urban frame survey (UFS) blocks. Ultimate stage units (USUs) are households or enterprises selected for detailed enquiry.

2. Stratification and Sub-stratification

Each district is treated as a stratum. Within each stratum, rural and urban sub-strata are formed. For sample allocation, proportional allocation is used across sub-strata based on population census data. Special strata are created for large industrial centers and tribal areas.

3. Estimation Procedure & Multipliers

Estimation of population parameters utilizes unbiased linear estimators. Multipliers are calculated as inverse probabilities of selection. For a two-stage design, the multiplier M_i for the i -th unit accounts for PSU selection probability and household selection probability within the selected PSU.

4. Non-Sampling Error Control Protocols

Field verification includes 100% check by supervisors on first-stage units and re-interviews on a 10% sample of ultimate stage units. Missing values are imputed using nearest-neighbor hot-deck methods to prevent bias in labor force and consumption estimates.